

Module 06: Learning — Practice Makes Perfect

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Practice** is how we get better at games.
2. Learn about **Skills** (Things you can do well).
3. Know that even the best players started as beginners.

Introduction: The Video Game Level Up

When you start a new video game, you are Level 1. You are weak. You don't know the controls. You start playing. You lose. You play again. Suddenly, you are Level 10! You have "Leveled Up" your brain. This is Learning.

Key Concepts

1. Repetition (The Grind)

To learn a skill (like shooting a basketball), you have to do it 1,000 times.

- Throw 1: Miss.
- Throw 50: Miss.
- Throw 100: Swish! Your brain needs the data from the misses to find the swish.

2. Muscle Memory (The Body Brain)

After enough practice, you don't have to think anymore.

- Tie shoes? Easy.
- Ride bike? Easy. Your muscles "remember" the movement. This frees up your brain to think about STRATEGY.

3. Coaching (The Teacher)

A Coach is someone who has already made the mistakes. They give you a shortcut. "Bend your knees." "Keep your eye on the ball." Listening to a coach helps you learn faster.

Activities

Activity 1: The 10-Second Challenge

Can you stand on one leg for 10 seconds? Try it. Easy? Now close your eyes. Harder! Practice 5 times. Does it get easier?

Activity 2: The Skill Swap

Teach your partner something ONLY YOU know how to do.

- A specific dance move.
- A magic trick.
- How to whistle. Now switch. What does it feel like to be the Beginner? The Teacher?

Summary

No one is born a Master. We become Masters by showing up, trying hard, and never giving up.

References

- *The Little Engine That Could* by Watty Piper
- *Giraffes Can't Dance* by Giles Andreae